CARD 5 | Deloitte Australia, 2025

The assurance review with invented references

What was reported

- Deloitte Australia was paid about 440,000 Australian dollars by Australia's Department of Employment and Workplace Relations for an "independent assurance review" of the automated penalty system in the welfare compliance framework. The 237-page report was published in July 2025.
- In August a university researcher, Chris Rudge, reported that it contained fabricated references, including a quotation attributed to a federal court judgment and sources that did not exist.
- A revised version published in October removed them and disclosed that a generative AI tool (Azure OpenAI) had been used. The department said the substance and recommendations were unchanged, and that Deloitte agreed to repay the final instalment of the contract.
- Deloitte said the matter had been resolved directly with the client.

The question for your pair

A report said something reassuring. What would you ask for before relying on it, and who checks the checker?

Write your control on a sticky note, then stick this card on the Incident Wall.

Sources: Associated Press (7 October 2025) via CTV News, KSAT and The Republic; City AM (8 October 2025); YourStory.